

Blood and Silk

A Starter Adventure for Fate's Edge

An Introduction to Exile, Redemption, and Second Chances

Adventure Type: Village Defense

Designed for 4-6 players, Rookie characters (0-40 XP)

Game Master's Guide Included

Featuring Pre-generated Characters
Simple Clock Management
Asset Building Through Heroism
Mutual Connections and Bonds

1 Introduction

1.1 Welcome to Acasia

Welcome to Fate's Edge, where every choice carries weight and every action has consequences. This starter adventure, "Blood and Silk," is designed to introduce new players to the core mechanics of the game while telling a story about redemption, community, and the power of second chances.

In the broken marches of Acasia, where law is a suggestion and coin speaks louder than crowns, a group of exiles finds themselves in a small farming village called Millhaven. What starts as a simple misunderstanding quickly escalates into a fight for survival as the village faces threats from all sides.

1.2 Adventure Overview

Adventure Hook: The PCs are exiles from Silkstrand - a cosmopolitan port city where they made choices that cost them their place in society. Now they wander the broken roads of Acasia, trying to survive and perhaps find a place where they belong.

Setting: Millhaven, a small farming village in the Acasian marches, threatened by bandits and political machinations.

Themes: Redemption, community, second chances, and the power of belonging.

Tone: Gritty but hopeful. Violence has consequences, but heroism can earn respect and a place to call home.

Recommended Character Tier: Rookie (0-40 XP) - perfect for new players.

Estimated Play Time: 2-3 sessions

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2 Session 0: Personalizing Your Exile

Before beginning play, take time to establish the connections between your characters and their shared past in Silkstrand. Discuss these questions with the group:

1. **The Final Straw:** What was the specific event in Silkstrand that forced you all to leave *together*?
2. **Defining Moment:** Look at your Mutual Bonds. Briefly describe the scene where that bond was formed. Was it during the event that exiled you, or on the road afterward?
3. **A Sliver of Hope:** Why is Millhaven different? What about this place makes you want to fight for it, instead of just moving on?

Example for Kestra and Marcus: Their bond is “We both made choices that cost us our place.” Perhaps Marcus refused an order to arrest Kestra during the library incident, sacrificing his career to help her escape.

3 The Story So Far

3.1 The Exiles of Silkstrand

The PCs are not welcome in their former home of Silkstrand. Whether they were involved in a scandal, crossed the wrong person, or simply made choices that powerful people didn't like, they now find themselves on the outside looking in. With nothing but the clothes on their backs and a burning desire to prove themselves, they've taken to the roads of Acasia.

3.2 Millhaven: A Village in Peril

Millhaven is a small farming community that has managed to stay neutral in the endless conflicts of Acasia. The village sits in a fertile valley surrounded by rolling hills, its thatched-roof cottages clustered around a central square where the weekly market is held. Smoke rises from chimneys in the morning mist, and the sound of children playing echoes through the narrow streets.

But peace is a luxury that's becoming increasingly expensive. The harvest has been poor this year, and bandit raids have left many families struggling. Now the Ursillo Gang has set their sights on the village, demanding “protection money” that would bankrupt the community.

The village is currently under threat from:

- **Bandits:** The Ursillo Gang, a particularly vicious group that demands “protection money”
- **Political Pressure:** Local nobles who want the village to choose sides in their conflicts
- **Economic Hardship:** Poor harvests and bandit raids have left the village struggling

4 Pre-Generated Characters

4.1 Character Creation Philosophy

These pre-generated characters are designed to be immediately playable while showcasing different approaches to character building in Fate's Edge. Each character has:

- Core Attributes and Skills appropriate for a rookie character (0-40 XP)
- A Background Hook that connects them to the setting

- Two Mutual Bonds with other characters (showing the bound->boon connection)
- Starting Assets and Boons to demonstrate resource management

4.2 Glossary of Key Terms

Before diving into the characters, here are brief definitions of key terms you'll encounter:

- **Bonds:** Mutual connections between characters that generate Boons when you help each other. Each bond represents a specific shared experience or debt.
- **Boons:** Narrative tokens earned primarily by failing rolls with meaningful consequences. Spend them to re-roll dice, activate Assets, or convert to XP.
- **XP (Experience Points):** Currency earned at the end of sessions to improve your character's Attributes, Skills, or acquire Assets and Talents.
- **SB (Story Beats):** Narrative fuel generated by rolling 1s on dice. The GM spends SB to add complications and twists to the story.

Kestra "The Scholar" - Arcanist

Background: Once a promising student at Silkstrand's Academy of Arts, Kestra was expelled after an experimental ritual went wrong, destroying part of the library. Now she seeks to prove that her knowledge can be used for good.

Attributes: Wits 3, Spirit 2

Skills: Arcana 2, Lore 2, Insight 1

Mutual Bonds:

- With Marcus: "We both made choices that cost us our place in Silkstrand"
- With Sariel: "She saved me from Ursillo bandits once, I owe her"

Starting Resources:

- 3 Boons
- Minor Asset: Scholar's Satchel (contains books, reagents, and a small telescope)
- Talent: Lorekeeper (Once per session, recall obscure history without rolling)

Marcus "The Blade" - Warrior

Background: A former city guard who was discharged after he refused to look the other way while corrupt officials shook down merchants. Now he makes his living as a sellsword, but his heart still yearns for justice.

Attributes: Body 3, Spirit 2

Skills: Melee 3, Athletics 2, Command 1

Mutual Bonds:

- With Kestra: "We both made choices that cost us our place in Silkstrand"
- With Elena: "We fought side by side against Ursillo raiders"

Starting Resources:

- 2 Boons
- Minor Asset: Trusted Blade (a well-maintained sword that never fails)
- Talent: Battle Instincts (Once per scene, re-roll a failed defense roll)

Sariel “The Shadow” - Scout

Background: A former member of Silkstrand’s Thieves’ Guild who grew tired of the constant violence and backstabbing. She left the guild but still uses her skills to survive on the road.

Attributes: Wits 3, Body 2

Skills: Stealth 2, Survival 2, Subterfuge 1

Mutual Bonds:

- With Kestra: “She saved me from Ursillo bandits once, I owe her”
- With Elena: “We both know what it’s like to be an outcast”

Starting Resources:

- 4 Boons
- Minor Asset: Shadow’s Cloak (grants advantage on stealth rolls in dim light)
- Talent: Silver Tongue (Gain +1 die when persuading or deceiving through speech)

Elena “The Healer” - Apothecary

Background: A former apothecary who was accused of practicing forbidden arts after she tried to save a patient with experimental treatments. Now she travels the roads, helping those who have nowhere else to turn.

Attributes: Spirit 3, Wits 2

Skills: Medicine 2, Survival 1, Insight 2

Mutual Bonds:

- With Marcus: “We fought side by side against Ursillo raiders”
- With Sariel: “We both know what it’s like to be an outcast”

Starting Resources:

- 3 Boons
- Minor Asset: Healer’s Kit (contains bandages, herbs, and basic medical supplies)
- Talent: Iron Stomach (Immune to mundane poisons and spoiled food)

Thane "The Artisan" - Craftsman

Background: A skilled blacksmith and engineer who was framed for sabotage by a rival guild in Silkstrand. His workshop was destroyed, and he was forced to flee with only his tools and his knowledge.

Attributes: Body 2, Wits 3

Skills: Craft 2, Engineering 2, Survival 1

Mutual Bonds:

- With Kestra: "We both lost our places of learning in Silkstrand"
- With Marcus: "He helped me escape when the guild sent enforcers"

Starting Resources:

- 2 Boons
- Minor Asset: Artisan's Tools (hammer, tongs, and a small forge kit)
- Talent: Exceptional Coordination (One follower provides +4 assist dice)

Note on Followers: A "follower" is an NPC companion who assists you regularly. Followers have a Cap rating (1-3) that determines how many dice they contribute when helping. Thane's talent makes a single follower exceptionally effective.

Lyra "The Diplomat" - Courtier

Background: A former court scribe who discovered too much about her lord's dark dealings. She fled Silkstrand with secret documents that could bring down several noble houses, but she's too principled to use them for personal gain.

Attributes: Presence 3, Wits 2

Skills: Diplomacy 2, Sway 2, Lore 1

Mutual Bonds:

- With Sariel: "We both know how to move through high society unnoticed"
- With Elena: "She helped me when I was injured fleeing Silkstrand"

Starting Resources:

- 3 Boons
- Minor Asset: Diplomatic Papers (official-looking documents that grant minor authority)
- Talent: Backlash Soothing (Reduce magical backlash by 1 SB)

Finn "The Beastmaster" - Ranger

Background: A former royal forester who was dismissed after he refused to help poachers kill a rare white stag that was sacred to the local spirits. He now travels with a loyal wolf companion and a deep respect for nature.

Attributes: Body 2, Spirit 3

Skills: Survival 2, Beastcraft 2, Archery 1

Mutual Bonds:

- With Thane: “We both lost our livelihoods to corruption”
- With Marcus: “He respects my commitment to protecting the innocent”

Starting Resources:

- 2 Boons
- Minor Asset: Wolf Companion (Cap 2 follower with tracking and combat abilities)
- Talent: Beast-Tongue (Communicate with and influence animals)

Zara “The Merchant” - Trader

Background: A clever trader who was run out of Silkstrand after she exposed a smuggling ring that included several city officials. She escaped with her life but lost her business and most of her wealth.

Attributes: Presence 2, Wits 3

Skills: Commerce 2, Subterfuge 2, Insight 1

Mutual Bonds:

- With Lyra: “We both uncovered corruption in Silkstrand’s elite”
- With Sariel: “We worked together to gather evidence against the smugglers”

Starting Resources:

- 4 Boons
- Minor Asset: Merchant’s Network (contacts in various towns and cities)
- Talent: Resourceful (Once per session, find useful items or information without rolling)

5 Core Mechanics Quick Reference

5.1 Attributes and Skills

Characters in Fate’s Edge have four Attributes (Body, Wits, Spirit, Presence) and a variety of Skills that represent specialized training.

Attributes (rated 1-5):

- **Body:** Strength, agility, endurance, and physical prowess
- **Wits:** Perception, quick thinking, memory, and intellect
- **Spirit:** Willpower, intuition, empathy, and magical talent
- **Presence:** Charisma, leadership, appearance, and force of personality

Common Skills:

- **Physical:** Melee, Ranged, Athletics, Stealth, Survival
- **Mental:** Arcana, Lore, Insight, Craft, Engineering, Medicine

- **Social:** Command, Sway, Diplomacy, Subterfuge, Commerce, Beastcraft

5.2 Making Rolls

In Fate's Edge, you resolve important actions by rolling dice:

1. **Determine the Approach:** Choose an Attribute + Skill combination
2. **Set Position:** GM sets Position (Dominant/Standard/Desperate)
3. **Roll Dice:** Roll a number of d10s equal to Attribute + Skill
4. **Count Results:**
 - Each 6+ = 1 Success
 - Each 1 = 1 Story Beat (SB)
5. **Apply Outcome:** Compare successes to DV (Difficulty Value, default 3)

5.3 Outcome Matrix

The GM sets a Difficulty Value (DV) for each roll. The default DV is 3, but may range from 2 (very easy) to 5+ (nearly impossible).

Result	Criteria	Effect
Clean Success	Successes $\geq$ DV, 0 SB	Intent achieved crisply, no complications
Success & Cost	Successes $\geq$ DV, 1+ SB	Intent achieved, GM spends SB on complications
Partial	$0 < \text{Successes} < \text{DV}$	Partial progress, may gain 1 Boon
Miss	Successes = 0	No progress, GM spends SB, gain 2 Boons

Note on “Clean Success”: This term means you met or exceeded the DV with no Story Beats (no 1s rolled). Your character succeeds without any narrative complications.

Note on Rerolls: When you fail a roll, you may reroll failures (not successes) if you have a relevant talent or asset. Otherwise, you accept the outcome.

5.4 Story Beats (SB)

SB are narrative fuel that the GM spends to add complications:

- **1 SB:** Minor pressure (noise, trace, +1 Supply segment)
- **2 SB:** Moderate setback (alarm, lose position, lesser foe)
- **3 SB:** Serious trouble (reinforcements, gear breaks, rail tick)
- **4+ SB:** Major turn (trap springs, authority arrives, scene shifts)

6 How to Run Encounter Boxes

Throughout this adventure, you'll find **encounter boxes** like the ones below. These are designed to be run as follows:

6.1 Reading an Encounter Box

Each encounter box contains:

- **Approach:** The recommended Attribute + Skill combination for the roll
- **Position:** The starting Position (Controlled/Risky/Desperate)
- **DV:** The Difficulty Value needed for success
- **Outcome descriptions:** What happens at each result level

6.2 Running the Encounter

1. **Set the scene:** Describe the situation to players
2. **Let players choose approach:** They may suggest alternatives to the listed approach
3. **Set Position and DV:** Use the box as a guideline, adjust based on circumstances
4. **Have player(s) roll:** One primary roller, others may assist
5. **Apply outcome:** Use the box descriptions, but adapt to your table's fiction

6.3 Example of Play

GM: "Garrick sneers at you. 'You think you can threaten me in my own camp?' Kestra, what do you do?"

Kestra: "I try to reason with him. Presence + Sway?"

GM: "That works. This is a Controlled position, DV 4. Roll your 4 dice."

Kestra: "I got 3 successes, but two 1s."

GM: "That's a Success & Cost. You convince him to leave, but I'm spending those 2 SB. As Garrick's men ride out, one of them snatches a child from the square. You've got a hostage situation now..."

6.4 Key Encounters

Social Encounter: Negotiating with Garrick

- **Approach:** Presence + Sway or Command
- **Position:** Controlled
- **DV:** 4
- **Clean Success:** Garrick leaves temporarily, but vows revenge
- **Success & Cost:** Garrick reduces his demand but takes a hostage (GM spends SB)
- **Partial:** Compromise reached with ongoing tension
- **Miss:** Combat starts immediately with Garrick having initiative

Combat Encounter: Fighting Ursillo Bandits

- **Approach:** Body + Melee or Wits + Subterfuge

- **Position:** Controlled (Desperate if outnumbered)
- **DV:** 3-4 depending on bandit type
- **Clean Success:** Bandit is defeated or routed
- **Success & Cost:** Bandit is wounded but still dangerous (GM spends SB)
- **Partial:** Temporary setback, bandit regroupes
- **Miss:** PC takes damage or is outmaneuvered

Investigation: Learning About Village Troubles

- **Approach:** Wits + Insight or Lore
- **Position:** Standard
- **DV:** 3
- **Clean Success:** Gain valuable information about Ursillo tactics
- **Success & Cost:** Learn something useful but with complications (GM spends SB)
- **Partial:** Learn something useful but incomplete
- **Miss:** Receive misleading information or waste time

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